

KARL-CHRISTIAN WOLFF-INGHAM

Design & Innovation Executive | UX & Product Design Leadership

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SUMMARY

Multidisciplinary UX and product design executive, engineering undergrad, design post-grad, and an Executive MBA from Brown and IE Business School. Twice transformed nascent design functions into enterprise organizations: SunTrust/BB&T through the \$66B merger that formed Truist, then Genuine Parts Company, where a research-led redesign of the \$8B B2B and retail commerce platform delivered an A/B-validated \$32.8M in attributed revenue (2025). Hands-on AI-native product work: shipped an agentic UX tool, publishes an agentic design thesis, and led the first GPC team outside its dedicated AI organization to operationalize AI tooling.

AI IN PRACTICE

- **Built:** Designer (try-designer.vercel.app), an experimental AI-native agentic UX harness (LangGraph + embedded Pi Agent); live and publicly usable.
- **Published:** Ongoing essay series on agentic, AI-first product design (Substack and LinkedIn): “[The Visible Layer](#),” “[The New Rules of Design and Code](#),” “[The Agentic UI Landscape](#).”
- **Code:** Hands-on AI-assisted development since early 2024; [GitHub](#) commit history from Nov 2024.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GENUINE PARTS COMPANY (GPC), Atlanta, GA

Jan 2023 – May 2026

Senior Director, Head of Product Design & Research

- Scaled the UX organization from 8 to 30+ (Design, UI, Research, Design Engineering); onshore/offshore model (Atlanta + Krakow); ~\$6M budget. Elevated UX from service tier to business-critical capability. C-Suite reporting.
- **Delivered \$32.8M in design-attributed revenue (2025):** led the research-driven redesign of the \$8B unified commerce platform spanning B2B professional (NAPA ProLink) and retail channels: an A/B-validated 7% add-to-cart improvement, built on the “Ways of Finding” strategy drawn from two years of research.
- **Owned Design System engineering** and built “Bolt,” GPC’s first design system adopted cross-regionally (North America, Europe, Asia Pacific), reducing design-to-engineering handoff friction; implemented a balanced-team operating model with dedicated design and research in OKR-aligned pods; design owns the how, while business and product own the what and the why.
- Led design for an AI-native agentic venture (stealth) executing the NAPA AutoCare AI strategy: agentic UI for service advisors, the customer-facing selling role in repair shops.
- Led the first team at GPC outside its dedicated AI organization to adopt and operationalize AI design/development tools (v0, Claude Code; adopted early 2025).

WOLFF CONSULTING, LLC, Atlanta, GA

Jun 2021 – Jan 2023

Founder & Principal Consultant

- **Authored the Future of NAPA AutoCare blueprint** for the GPC CIO: including AI-assisted repair diagnoses (Aug 2022, three months before ChatGPT launched); led to recruitment to execute the vision at GPC.
- Additional clients: FitRadio, Comscore, Gold’s Gym. Concurrently co-founded Elysium Applications and shipped Talk Droid to the iPhone App Store.

TRUIST FINANCIAL, Atlanta, GA

Dec 2019 – Jun 2021

SVP, UX Design & Research — Commercial Banking and Small Business

- Post-merger build-out, scaling organization to ~50 across UX, UI, and Research; led design and research across Commercial Banking, Small Business, Wealth Management rebuilding those applications for the merged bank.

SUNTRUST BANKS, Atlanta, GA

Jul 2017 – Dec 2019

SVP, UX Design & Research

- Inherited a 10-person team; established UI and UX Research as new functions and scaled the design organization to ~25 by the December 2019 merger; ~\$5M budget.
- **Drove the Future of Banking Strategy engagement** (Jobs-to-Be-Done at business-unit level) whose three banking-future scenarios CEO Bill Rogers called “instrumental” to SunTrust’s merger strategy; rebooted the

Innovation Accelerator Studio around Customer Journeys and Strategic Foresight; founded the Service Design practice.

- Integrated voice-of-customer (design + research) into the bank's Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) adoption, modernizing the software development lifecycle.
- Third-party validation: Javelin 'Overall Category Leader' (Online & Mobile Banking) within 12 months; Mitek mobile deposit rose 6 places to 5th in the U.S.; developed Andy Vitale (later Head of Design, Rocket Mortgage).

SPARKS GROVE, Atlanta, GA

Sep 2014 – Mar 2017

UX Design Practice Leader, Experience Design – Agency division of North Highland Consulting

- Won \$2.7M+ in new business (Delta Air Lines, including news.delta.com, still live; Coca-Cola; Disney; Universal; The Home Depot); led the agency's shift to agile/lean product as de facto product practice lead; National Impact Award for the Human Experience Design repositioning.

TURNER BROADCASTING (Time Warner), Atlanta, GA

Apr 2005 – Mar 2014

VP, Product Management – upwave.com (Oct 2012 – Mar 2014)

- Led product and UX for Turner's pre-Apple-Watch digital-health venture linking wearables to personalized content; grew upwave from 0 to 1M monthly uniques in 8 months (recirculation 5% to 24%; IDEO partner; Webby nomination).

Senior Director, Strategic Product Development (Dec 2008 – Oct 2012)

- Built Turner's interactive sync to TV platform: two granted patents (co-inventor) + Emmy contribution (Team Coco). Created CNN "Notify" push notification platform (ROI in 4 months); led on-air AR for CNN elections coverage; designed the World Cup Twitter Buzz (RTS Innovation Award).

Director, Games & Entertainment Technologies (Apr 2005 – Dec 2008)

- Created the first U.S. mobile AR apps (NBA, Cartoon Network) with Georgia Tech, pre-iPhone; brokered Perceptive Pixel multi-touch into CNN (the Magic Wall); academic partnerships with Dr. Ian Bogost (CNN.com news games) and Dr. Richard M. Ryan (Self-Determination Theory).

Earlier (UK, 1991–2005): *Ensequence International (Interactive TV Architect; BSkyB, BBC). Two Way TV, founding-team member; first interactive-TV multiplayer game service; BAFTA Interactive nomination.*

EDUCATION

Executive MBA, Brown University & IE Business School (joint program), USA & Spain

2019

MSc. Human-Centered Computing Systems, University of Sussex, UK

1994

Focus: AI & Intelligent Tutoring Systems. Apple Design Project Award.

BSc. (Hons) Computer Science, University of Brighton, UK

1993

- **Dissertation "Colonizing Cyberspace" (March 1993):** Laid out theory for globally networked information and communities, before the first Mosaic browser launched. Technical project: extended HyperCard's HyperTalk with AI neural-network back-propagation (commands) – precursor to today's Large Language Models.

SKILLS

Design & Org: Product design & Strategy, organizational transformation, design systems, design thinking, UX research, service design, balanced-team operating models, agile UX at scale (SAFe), strategic foresight, Jobs-to-Be-Done, C-suite influence, M&A integration, B2B, B2C, Consulting.

AI & Innovation: Agentic UX, AI-native product design, AI/ML product design, hands-on AI build (v0, Windsurf, Gemini, Claude Code, Cursor; LangGraph, Pi Agent), evidence-based design.

Research & Analytics: Stakeholder engagement, A/B testing and experimentation, qualitative and quantitative research, usability testing, Mixpanel, Adobe Analytics, LogRocket, Glassbox.

Certifications: Creative Leadership (IDEO); Foresight Practitioner (The Futures School); Product Management (Pragmatic Institute); SAFe / Scrum Master; Behavioral Design - Persuasion, Emotion, Trust (HFI).

Patents & Recognition: Co-inventor on US9043821B2 & US9167276B2 (automatic content recognition, granted 2015). Primetime Creative Arts Emmy (team, 2011). RTS Innovation Award (2010). Fast Company "Infographic of the Day" (2010). Webby nomination (2014). BAFTA Interactive nomination (2000).